Batch 4: paragraph-level and cross-chapter edits (25 items)

2026-11-10. From `runs/qa/2026-11-07-edits-ch00-ch16.json`. Six of the 31 were already settled by edits you approved: Q038, Q044, Q062, Q068, Q072 and Q093. They are marked resolved.

A. Approve as a group (16): the Line Editor applies, I verify

Each is a small, contained edit. Say “A approved” to take them all, or name the IDs to leave out.

- **Q002 · Prologue L37:** “She told me, in her own words, that I’d gone somewhere she couldn’t follow me to.” becomes “She noticed

before I did. She told me so, and she was right.” Ch16 now carries her actual words, so the Prologue shouldn’t paraphrase them. This also covers **Q015** (the same story told in full twice). - **Q013 · Ch3 and Ch13 openings:** five chapters open on “There’s a [thing] you didn’t choose.” Vary two of them. Ch3 becomes “When she criticizes you, your answer is ready before she’s finished, and you never chose it. You learned it.” - **Q024 · Ch2 and Ch5 openings:** both open by recapping the chapter before. Ch2 becomes “Something has been deciding how you feel when you walk through your own door, and you never signed off on it.” Ch5 becomes “You’re already inside a real fight, and everything from the last four chapters gets used at once.” Ch8’s recap opening was already fixed. - **Q048 · section labels in Ch11, Ch13 and Ch14:** these read like instructions (“Be there for the time you share.”). Use the descriptive style Ch16 uses, e.g. “The time you share.”

and “Still learning her.” Ch15’s three “Meet X with Y” labels stay, because they are its structure. - **Q061 · “Tuesday”:** it’s the default day in seven chapters. Keep Ch1 and Ch6’s opening; vary Ch2, Ch6 L35 and Ch10 (twice). - **Q083 · Ch7:** “That’s not X. That’s Y.” appears three times against a cap of 2. Rework one of them. - **Q110 · Ch15 L23:** the same “Chapter 11 covers…” pointer appears in Ch14 and Ch15. Ch15’s becomes “If a remark still hurts you every time, tell her, the way you’d raise anything else that keeps coming back.” - **Q120 · Ch16 L37:** it re-teaches preferred indifferents with Ch2’s sentence word for word. It becomes “Her happiness is one of those things. It doesn’t decide who I am, and I still want it more than almost anything. I want my wife happy.” - **Q121 · Ch16 L49:** “a place the two of you own” becomes “a house the two of you own”, so the chapter’s image is named plainly. The image count stays the same (4.8 per 1,000; cap

5). - **Q128 · Ch16 chapter references:** about 10 “Chapter N” references make the capstone read like a review. Drop the chapter number at L37, L49 and L65. Keep the Introduction callback, the Ch1 link for arête, and the L15 line you approved. - **Q130 · Ch16 L31:** use Ch2’s name for the idea, “care without contagion”, so compassion reads as the same idea and not a new one. - **Q132 · Ch16 L51:** “Some of it comes from the seasons” becomes “Some of it is just age.” The Introduction uses “seasons” for the Oak. - **Q019 · Ch1, “you” below the minimum (33.8 per 1,000; the minimum is 40):** turn a few general sentences into “you” sentences to reach 40. The stories stay in first person. - **Q060 and Q067 · one mechanical typography pass:** - one numeral style for citations (Arabic or Roman); - one form for translator credits; - straight vs. curly quotes made consistent; - Ch10’s hard-wrapped lines unwrapped; - Ch2’s quotation credit loses its em-dash, which is the Ch2 fail.

B. Two editorial passes: bigger, recommend yes

- **Q012 · repeated biographies:** Marcus gets his private-notebook introduction in five chapters, Epictetus his in three, and the dichotomy of control is explained from scratch four times. *Recommend:* keep the full introduction the first time; after that, one clause such as "Marcus Aurelius, the emperor whose private notes became the *Meditations*", never in the same words twice. - **Q053 and Q056 · study caveats in Ch12–15:** research inserts with two or three caveats cool the warm chapters. *Recommend:* one sentence per study, with the honest caveat kept as a clause, not a paragraph. The book has no endnotes, so nothing moves there. (Ch14's classroom study was already cut.) One reader persona dissents: Eric wants the evidence on the page.

C. Your call (5)

- Q014 and Q018 · Prologue and Introduction, “you” below the minimum (31.5 and 29.9 per 1,000): these are memoir and manifesto, written as “I” by design. - *Recommend:* exempt the Prologue and Introduction from the “you” rule. - That is a change to the voice spec, so I need your words for it, e.g. “Exempt the Prologue and Introduction from you-density.” - **Q011 · River, Oak and Sun in chapter text:** the rule says the elements appear only on the Part pages. Ch15 (“When you are the sun”) and Ch16 (the three arc names) already go past that. - *Recommend:* amend the rule so a chapter that closes a Part may name the elements, keep Ch15’s sun line, and don’t add Ch10’s “The oak holds firm”. - This is also a voice spec change, so it needs your words. - **Q107 · your wife’s own lines in Ch14–15:** by

Ch15 the reader has read her complaints verbatim: “hoarders”, “very anxious”, the Saturday lines. She will read the book. - *Recommend:* confirm she’s comfortable with these as written. If not, I’ll soften them. - **Q127 · arête:** it is first named in Ch16 (inbox #164). - *Recommend:* leave it there, since the idea has been in Ch1 all along, and make sure the Desert chapters (Ch17–23) use the word at least once before Ch25 comes back to it. This adds a note to the outline. - **Q126 · notes for future chapters:** Ch16 now covers ground Ch24–26 planned to use: daily investment, the house, “she’s my best friend”. - *Recommend:* add a note to those chapters’ outlines so Ch24 recalls Ch16’s house in a clause instead of re-arguing it, and Ch26’s realization stays the reader’s, not yours.